

English Ladder

Teaching Guide

That vs Which: Understanding Essential and Non-Essential Information

A concise classroom guide with lesson flow, teaching cues, and a ready-to-use answer key built around the same English Ladder concept sheet.



Grammar Concepts #12

Key Points

Summary

Visual anchor

Use the concept poster to spotlight the main language pattern in **That vs Which: Understanding Essential and Non-Essential Information** and keep the explanation visible during practice and discussion.

ENGLISH LADDER

Concept #12 ▶ **That vs Which**

When the information included **is essential** to the meaning of a sentence, we use **"that"** without commas.

When the information included **is not essential** to the meaning of a sentence, we use **"which"** with commas.

The shape that is red is called a "cube".		The shape, which is red, is a cube.	
The tool that is completely silver is called a "wrench".		The tool, which is completely silver, is a wrench.	
The animal that has big ears is an elephant.		The animal, which has a hump, is a camel.	

* If the subject is a person, the word "who" is used in both cases. But commas are still used when the information is not essential.

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At a Glance

Lesson focus That vs Which: Understanding Essential and Non-Essential Information	Suggested timing 45-60 minutes
Core objective Students explain the target pattern clearly and apply it accurately in controlled practice and discussion.	Materials Student PDF, the concept image, board space, and time for partner checking.

Suggested Lesson Flow

Warm-up

Display the concept image and ask learners to predict the rule behind **That vs Which: Understanding Essential and Non-Essential Information** before reading the explanation.

Model

Walk through the Core Idea and the sections on Key Points, Summary. Pause after each part so students can restate the pattern in plain English.

Guided practice

Project two or three examples from the concept sheet and ask pairs to explain why each choice works, not just what the answer is.

Independent work

Assign the 24 practice items for quiet work, partner checking, and final feedback.

Closure

Ask students to create one new sentence or mini-example of their own that follows the same pattern.

Likely Learner Errors

- Learners may overgeneralize the first pattern they notice. Keep returning to **Key Points, Summary** and ask students to explain what changes from one example to the next.
- Long explanations can hide the signal word or structure. Have students underline the exact phrase that tells them which form, pattern, or response is needed.
- If students can choose an answer but cannot explain it, ask them to justify their choice using words taken directly from the concept sheet.

Differentiation and Delivery Notes



- Support: teach one section at a time, then send students back to **the examples** or the practice set so they can apply the same rule immediately.
- Pair work: let students compare answers aloud before you reveal the key. The explanation step is as important as the final answer.
- Extension: ask stronger students to write two fresh examples or a short dialogue that uses the same target language accurately.

Model Language from the Concept Sheet

- The shape that is red is called a "cube". Here, "that is red" is essential because it specifies which shape is being referred to.
- The tool that is completely silver is called a "wrench". "That is completely silver" is essential to identify the specific tool.
- The animal that has big ears is an elephant. "That has big ears" is essential to specify which animal.
- The book that has a blue cover is mine.
- The car that is parked outside belongs to John.
- The student that studies the most often gets the best grades.



Answer Key

Use this key for whole-class feedback or fast marking.

Item 01 The house that is on the corner is blue.

Item 02 The car, which is red, is very fast.

Item 03 The book that I borrowed was excellent.

Item 04 My phone, which is very old, still works fine.

Item 05 The movie that we watched last night was scary.

Item 06 The flowers, which are on the table, are for you.

Item 07 The student that studies the hardest usually succeeds.

Item 08 My computer, which is very fast, helps me work efficiently.

Item 09 The song that she sang was beautiful.

Item 10 The cake, which was chocolate, was delicious.

Item 11 The book that has a red cover is mine.

Item 12 The car, which is parked outside, is my sister's.

Item 13 The dog that barked all night kept us awake.

Item 14 My brother, who lives in New York, is visiting us.

Item 15 The bike that I ride is very old.

Item 16 The movie, which stars my favorite actor, is a hit.

Item 17 The building that collapsed was very old.

Item 18 The painting, which was stolen, is very valuable.

Item 19 The restaurant that we went to was expensive.

Item 20 The shoes, which are black, are very comfortable.

Item 21 The film that we watched last night was interesting.



Item 22 The tree, which is very old, provides a lot of shade.

Item 23 The cat that caught the mouse is very clever.

Item 24 The teacher, who assigned the homework, is very strict.
